

Carrier / method	Slot pad (B)	Packet-positive positions	Skipped positions	Zero-bit positions	Completion positions	Packet bits / span symbol	Suffix bits
UTF-8 / Fixed	0.0	584.00	0.00	0.00	32.00	4.000	0.0
UTF-8 / Gated	0.0	584.00	39.80	0.00	32.00	3.747	0.0
UTF-8 / A1	0.0	399.40	0.00	1648.60	0.00	—	0.0
PNG / Fixed	162.8	584.00	0.00	0.00	2392.00	4.000	0.0
PNG / Gated	162.8	584.00	100.50	0.00	2291.50	3.451	0.0
PNG / A1	162.8	508.20	0.00	89.65	2378.15	3.934	28.9

Framing, padding and carrier-position overhead. Descriptive cell means over 20 held-out attempts. Every packet is 292 B: 36 B framing/encryption plus the 256 B payload slot. Rank alignment adds zero padding bits. The four position columns partition delivered symbols: packet-positive + skipped + zero-bit + completion. A1’s one successful termination position is already among packet-positive positions, never another position to add. Packet-span transport is 2,336 / packet stopping position (including skips/zero-bit steps), undefined for unfinished A1 text. Whole-carrier packet rates and file expansion are in the CSV. A1 PNG suffix bits (mean 28.9) are discarded zero-extension emissions, not useful packet bits; lookahead zeros (mean 29.9, CSV) overlap that diagnostic and must not be summed with it. A1 text reaches neither suffix processing nor completion.